

and up to one hundred cors of wheat, and up to one hundred baths of wine, and up to one hundred baths of oil, and salt without prescribing it.

23 Whatsoever is ordered by the God of heaven shall be carefully done for the house of the God of heaven; for why should there be wrath against the kingdom of the king and his sons?

24 And to you make we it known, that on any of the priests and Levites, singers, gatekeepers, and temple-servants, or ministers of this house of God, no one shall be empowered to impose any tax, tribute, or toll.

25 And thou, 'Ezra, according to the wisdom of thy God which is in thy hand, appoint judges and magistrates, who are to judge all the people that are beyond the river, all such as know the laws of thy God; and make ye them known to those^a that know them not.

26 And if there be any one who will not execute the law of thy God, and the law of the king, let justice be speedily executed upon him, whether it be unto death or to banishment,^b or to a fine on goods, or to imprisonment.

27 ¶ Blessed be the LORD the God of our fathers, who hath put the like of this in the heart of the king, to glorify the house of the LORD which is in Jerusalem;

28 And who hath extended kindness unto me before the king and his counsellors, and before all the mighty princes of the king: and I strengthened myself according to the hand of the LORD my God upon me, and I gathered together out of Israel principal men to go up with me.

CHAPTER VIII.

1 ¶ Now these are the chiefs of their divisions, and this is the genealogy of those that went up with me, in the reign of king Artaxerxes, from Babylon.

2 Of the sons of Phinchas, Gershom; of the sons of Ithamar, Daniel; of the sons of David, Chattush;

3 Of the sons of Shechanyah, (who was) of the sons of Par'osh, Zechariah; and with

him were recorded by genealogy of males one hundred and fifty.

4 Of the sons of 'Pachath-mo'ab, Elyeho-'enai the son of 'Zerachyah, and with him were two hundred males.

5 Of the sons of Shechanyah, the son of Yachaziël, and with him were three hundred males.

6 And of the sons of 'Adin, 'Ebed the son of Jonathan, and with him were fifty males.

7 And of the sons of 'Elam, Jesha'yah the son of 'Athalyah, and with him were seventy males.

8 And of the sons of Shephatyah, Zebadyah the son of Michaël, and with him were eighty males.

9 Of the sons of Jo'ab, 'Obadiah the son of Jechiël, and with him were two hundred and eighteen males.

10 And of the sons of Shelomith, the son of Jossiptyah, and with him were one hundred and sixty males.

11 And of the sons of Bebai, Zechariah the son of Bebai, and with him were twenty and eight males.

12 And of the sons of 'Azgad, Jochanan the son of Hakkatan, and with him were one hundred and ten males.

13 And of the sons of Adonikam the last; and these are their names, Elipelet, Je'iel, and Shema'yah, and with them were sixty males.

14 And of the sons of Bigvai, 'Uthai, and Zabbur, and with them were seventy males.

15 ¶ And I gathered them together to the river that runneth into the Ahava, and we encamped there three days: and I looked about among the people, and the priests, but of the sons of Levi I found none there.

16 Then sent I for Eli'ezer, for Ariël, for Shema'yah, and for Elnathan, and for Jarib, and for Elnathan, and for Nathan, and for Zechariah, and for Meshullam, the head men; also for Joyarib, and for Elnathan, men of understanding.^c

17 And I sent them with a charge unto Iddo the chief at the place Cassiphia, and I laid the words in their mouth to speak unto Iddo, and to his brother,^d who were appoint-

^a Rashi explains this to refer to the judges. By this edict the Israelites were to be judged after the Jewish, not the Persian laws, and 'Ezra was to be the chief justice, but not the civil governor.

^b Rashi, "extermination."

^c Rashi; but Fürst, "teachers."

^d Rashi would translate this *Achie*, as a proper name, not "his brother."